

# OpenClaw Switch Models

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## OpenClaw Switch Models

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## 1. Course Content

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This course systematically introduces OpenClaw's model selection working mechanism and three model switching operation methods.

## 2. Temporarily Switch Session Model

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### 2.1 Open TUI Session

- Enter in terminal

```
openclaw tui
```

### 2.2 Use /model to Switch Session Model

| Command             | Description                                         |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <code>/model</code> | View available model list, select and switch models |

- Enter `/model` in the session box. For example, here select to switch to `bailian/qwen3.5-plus`, use the up/down arrow keys to select the model, then press Enter

## 3. Switch Default Model

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### 3.1 Switch via CLI

The simplest way is to use the CLI command to directly set the default model:

- Here, switching to the `bailian/qwen3.6-plus` model is used as an example

```
openclaw models set bailian/qwen3.6-plus
```

```
Updated ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Default model: bailian/qwen3.6-plus
jietson@vahboom:~$
```

## 3.2 Switch via Configuration File

- Edit the `openclaw.json` configuration file to modify the Agent's default model

```
nano $HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json
# Or use your preferred editor, such as vim, code, etc.
```

In `openclaw.json`, specify the default primary model through the `agents.defaults.model.primary` configuration item:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
    }
  }
}
```

- Verify if the configuration has taken effect:

```
openclaw models status
```

```
Before runtime loads
Config       : ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Agent dir    : ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent
Default      : bailian/qwen3.5-plus
Fallbacks (0) : -
Image model   : -
Image fallbacks (0): -
Aliases (0)   : -
Configured models (9): bailian/qwen3.5-plus, bailian/qwen3.6-plus, bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23, bailian/qwen3-coder-next, bailian/qwen3-coder-plus, bailian/MiniMax-M2.5, bailian/glm-5, bailian/glm-4.7, bailian/kimi-k2.5
```

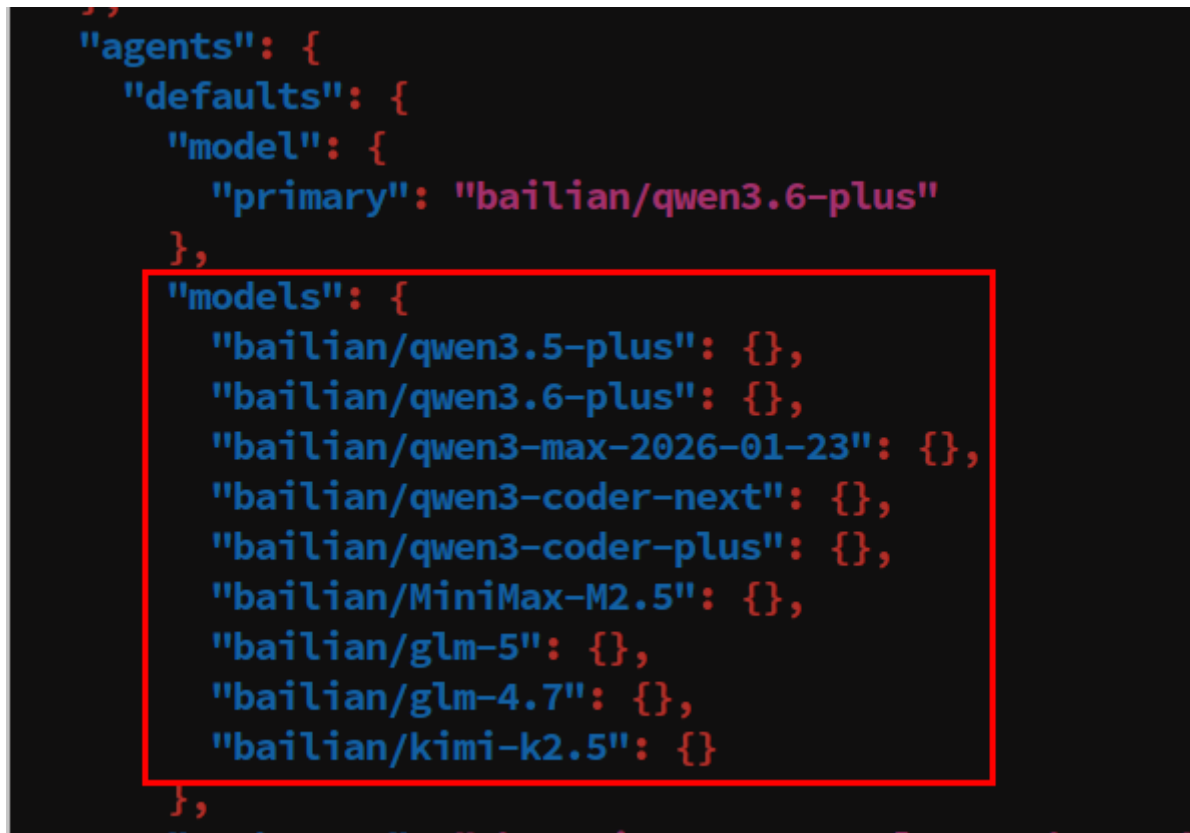
## 4. Add Model Option List

- `agents.defaults.models` is an **allow list/directory** in OpenClaw that controls the range of available models. Once this configuration item is set, users can only use models included in the list. This list simultaneously serves as the model range control basis for the `/model` command and session overrides.

## 4.1 Add Models via Configuration File

Configure `agents.defaults.models` in `openc1aw.json` to add the models you need to use to the allow list:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      },
      "models": {
        "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
        "bailian/qwen3.6-plus": {},
        "bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23": {},
        "bailian/qwen3-coder-next": {},
        "bailian/qwen3-coder-plus": {},
        "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
        "bailian/glm-5": {},
        "bailian/glm-4.7": {},
        "bailian/kimi-k2.5": {}
      }
    }
  }
}
```



```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.6-plus"
    },
    "models": {
      "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3.6-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-coder-next": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-coder-plus": {},
      "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
      "bailian/glm-5": {},
      "bailian/glm-4.7": {},
      "bailian/kimi-k2.5": {}
    }
  }
}
```

## 4.2 Add Agent Model List via CLI Command

Use the `openc1aw config set` command to safely edit the allow list without manually modifying the JSON file:

```
openc1aw config set agents.defaults.models.bailian/qwen3-plus '{}'
```

```

"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.6-plus"
    },
    "models": {
      "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3.6-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-coder-next": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-coder-plus": {},
      "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
      "bailian/glm-5": {},
      "bailian/glm-4.7": {},
      "bailian/kimi-k2.5": {},
      "openai/gpt-5.4": {}
    }
  }
},

```

## 4.3 Model Reference Format Specification

In OpenClaw, all model references use a unified format:

```
provider/model-id
```

Examples:

| Model Reference               | Description                                     |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| anthropic/claude-opus-4-6     | Anthropic Claude Opus model                     |
| anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6   | Anthropic Claude Sonnet model                   |
| openai/gpt-5.4                | OpenAI GPT-5.4 model                            |
| openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2 | Case where the model ID itself contains a slash |

**Note:** If the model ID itself contains `/` (such as `moonshotai/kimi-k2`), the full `openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2` format must be provided for the reference.

## 5. Appendix: CLI Command Quick Reference

| Command                                                                    | Usage                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>openclaw onboard</code>                                              | New user guide, helps quickly complete initial configuration |
| <code>openclaw models list</code>                                          | View all configured model lists                              |
| <code>openclaw models status</code>                                        | View current model configuration status details              |
| <code>openclaw config set<br/>agents.defaults.models '&lt;json&gt;'</code> | Safely add models to the allow list                          |
| <code>/model</code>                                                        | View available model list in chat                            |
| <code>/model status</code>                                                 | View current model status details in chat                    |